

Ch 2: Federalism

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

- Q1. What is federalism? What are its two levels of government?**
- Q2. What are the dual objectives of a federal system?**
- Q3. Distinguish between a federal system and a unitary system of government with one example each.**
- Q4. What is a 'coming together' federation? Give two examples.**
- Q5. What is a 'holding together' federation? Give two examples.**
- Q6. In which year did Belgium shift from a unitary to a federal form of government? Why?**
- Q7. What is the Union List? Give two examples of subjects in it.**
- Q8. What is the State List? Give two examples of subjects in it.**
(PYQ Term-1 2021-22)
- Q9. What is the Concurrent List? Give two examples of subjects in it.**
- Q10. Which list includes subjects like banking, currency, defence, and foreign affairs? (PYQ)**

Q11. Which list includes subjects like business, agriculture, and police? (PYQ Term-1 2021-22)

Q12. Both the Union and State governments can make laws on subjects in which list? (PYQ)

Q13. What happens when there is a conflict between central and state laws on a Concurrent List subject?

Q14. What is a Residuary Subject? Who has power over residuary subjects in India?

Q15. How many languages are included in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution?

Q16. What is a linguistic state? Give one example. How was it created?

Q17. What was the States Reorganisation Act? When was it passed?

Q18. What is the language policy of India? Is there a national language in India?

Q19. What is decentralisation? Why is it important in a federal system?

Q20. When was the third tier of government — the local self-government — given constitutional status in India?

Q21. What are Gram Sabhas? What is their role in rural local government?

Q22. What is a Panchayati Raj system? At how many levels does it function?

Q23. What is a Municipality? Who is the head of a Municipal Corporation?

Q24. Which subjects are included in the Residuary List? Who has the power to legislate on them?

Q25. Can a state government stop the Union government from implementing a currency policy? Why or why not? (PYQ)

Q26. What is the role of the judiciary in a federal system?

Q27. What is the significance of the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments?

Q28. Name two states in India that enjoy a special status under the Constitution.

Q29. What is coalition government? Is it a feature of federalism?

Q30. Give one difference between how federalism works in the USA and in India.

Q31. What is the importance of an independent judiciary in a federal system?

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

- Q1. Explain the three-fold distribution of legislative powers in India. Give two examples of subjects under each list. (PYQ — frequently asked)**
- Q2. Distinguish between the federal and unitary systems of government. Give three differences with examples. (PYQ)**
- Q3. Explain three key features of federalism that make it different from a unitary system.**
- Q4. Explain the difference between 'coming together' and 'holding together' federations. Give two examples of each. (PYQ)**
- Q5. How has India accommodated linguistic diversity through its federal system? Explain three measures. (PYQ)**
- Q6. Explain any three policies adopted by India to make its federal system successful. (PYQ)**
- Q7. Explain the language policy of India. Why was Hindi not declared the national language?**
- Q8. What is decentralisation? Why was it considered necessary in India? Explain three reasons. (PYQ)**
- Q9. Explain the significance of the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments for local self-government in India.**
- Q10. Explain the three levels of the Panchayati Raj system in India. What are the functions of each level?**

Q11. How are municipalities and gram panchayats different in terms of their functions, composition, and areas of jurisdiction?

Q12. What is a Gram Sabha? Explain its role and significance in rural democracy.

Q13. What subjects does the Union List contain? Why are these subjects kept under central control? Give three reasons.

Q14. What subjects does the State List contain? Why are these subjects given to state governments? Give three reasons.

Q15. What subjects does the Concurrent List contain? Why is this list necessary? Give three examples.

Q16. Explain the role of the judiciary in resolving disputes between the Centre and states in India. Give three points.

Q17. Explain any three ways in which the Centre has more power than the states in India's federal system.

Q18. Is India a true federation? Give three arguments both for and against this claim.

Q19. Explain three challenges faced by India's federal system in maintaining a balance between central authority and state autonomy.

Q20. Why is decentralisation considered the third tier of democracy in India? Explain three benefits of decentralisation.

Q21. How does the Panchayati Raj system strengthen grassroots democracy in India? Explain three points.

Q22. What are the features of the Indian federal system that make it different from the USA federal system? Give three points.

Q23. Explain three reasons why the demand for creating new states in India is often raised on linguistic or ethnic grounds.

Q24. Explain how the creation of linguistic states helped in maintaining national unity in India. Give three examples.

Q25. "India's Constitution originally gave more powers to the Central Government." Explain three reasons why this was done.

Q26. Explain the concept of Local Self Government. How does it differ from state and central government in terms of power and functions?

Q27. How are Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes given representation in local government bodies? Explain three provisions.

Q28. Explain three ways in which the growth of regional parties has strengthened Indian federalism.

Q29. Explain why the relationship between the Centre and states is often described as 'cooperative federalism'. Give three examples.

Q30. How has the reorganisation of states on linguistic lines since 1956 affected the federal structure of India? Give three impacts.

Q31. Explain three features of federalism that help protect the rights of minority communities within a country.

Q32. Explain the concept of 'Residuary Powers' in a federal system. Who holds them in India and in the USA? What does this difference indicate?

Q33. Describe the role of the State Election Commission in ensuring free and fair elections to local government bodies.

Q34. Explain three reasons why local self-government is considered an important step towards deepening democracy in India.

Q35. How have coalition governments at the Centre since the 1990s changed the nature of Centre-state relations in India? Give three points.

Q36. Explain any three functions of Urban Local Bodies — Municipalities and Municipal Corporations — in Indian cities.

Q37. Explain the significance of reserved seats for women in local government bodies under the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

Q38. Describe how the process of decentralisation was carried out in India after 1992. What were its main features?

Q39. Explain three ways in which the Indian federal system has evolved over time to give more power to states.

Q40. Explain three reasons why federalism is particularly important for large and diverse countries like India.

Q41. Explain three differences between Panchayati Raj institutions and Municipal bodies in terms of area, composition, and functions.

Q42. How does an independent judiciary help in maintaining the federal structure of India? Explain three specific roles.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. Explain the three-fold distribution of legislative powers between the Centre and states in India. Give two examples of subjects under each list and explain what happens in case of conflict. (PYQ — most repeated)

Q2. Explain the key features of federalism. How does India's federal system reflect these features? Give five examples. (PYQ)

Q3. Distinguish between 'coming together' and 'holding together' federations with five points. Give examples of each type and explain which type India belongs to. (PYQ)

Q4. How has India successfully managed linguistic and regional diversity through its federal system? Explain five measures taken by the government. (PYQ)

Q5. What is decentralisation? Explain why it was considered necessary in India. Describe the changes brought about by the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments.

Q6. Describe the Panchayati Raj system in India. Explain its three levels, functions, and significance for rural democracy.

Q7. Explain how the reorganisation of states on linguistic lines strengthened Indian federalism. Give five examples of states created on linguistic grounds and their significance.

Q8. "India is a federal country but with a strong Centre." Justify this statement with five examples showing where the Centre has more power than the states.

Q9. Explain the role of the local self-government in deepening democracy in India. How have the 73rd and 74th Amendments changed the nature of grassroots governance?

Q10. Compare the federal systems of India and the USA across five parameters — distribution of power, role of judiciary, residuary powers, relationship between Centre and states, and constitutional provisions.

Q11. Explain how the language policy of India has helped maintain national unity while respecting linguistic diversity. Give five specific provisions and their significance.

Q12. Explain the evolution of Centre-state relations in India since independence. How have coalition governments and the rise of regional parties changed the power balance?

Q13. Describe the significance of Panchayati Raj institutions for women, Scheduled Castes, and Scheduled Tribes in India. How has reservation helped these groups participate in governance?

Q14. "Federalism is not just about dividing power — it is about ensuring that different levels of government work together for the common good." Justify with five examples from India.

Q15. Explain the dual objectives of federalism. How does India's Constitution try to achieve both objectives simultaneously? Give five specific constitutional provisions.

Q16. Describe the three tiers of government in India. Explain the powers and functions of each tier with specific examples.

Q17. Explain how decentralisation has helped bring government closer to the people in India. Give five specific examples of functions transferred to local bodies.

Q18. How have regional political parties and coalition governments strengthened Indian federalism since the 1990s? Explain with five examples.

Q19. Explain the federal features of the Indian Constitution. Also explain where the Constitution gives the Centre more powers and why this asymmetry was considered necessary.

Q20. Describe the process and significance of the creation of new states in India. How does this reflect the federal nature of the Indian state? Give five examples of states created after independence.

Q21. Explain five ways in which local self-government in India has both succeeded and failed in achieving the goals of decentralisation and grassroots democracy.

Q22. Compare the federal systems of India and Belgium. How has each country used federalism to manage its ethnic and linguistic diversity?

Q23. Explain the concept of cooperative federalism with five examples from India showing how the Centre and states work together on issues of common importance.

Q24. Explain the role of the judiciary in maintaining India's federal structure. How does the Supreme Court resolve Centre-state conflicts? Give five examples.

Q25. "True federalism requires not just constitutional division of powers but also financial autonomy for states." Explain this statement with five points covering taxation, grants, and financial relations between Centre and states in India.

Q26. Describe the Gram Sabha and Gram Panchayat system in India. How do they function? What powers do they have? What are the challenges they face in practice?